

Generated from the competition table

1986 FIFA World Cup

Everything the FIFA World Cup edition table records about 1986, with each placing linked to that team's full history.

Host(s)

Mexico

Teams

24

Winner

Argentina

Runner-up

West Germany

Third

France

Fourth / other semifinalist

Belgium

Final

**Argentina 3-2 West
Germany**

Final date

29 June 1986

Top scorer

**Gary Lineker
(England, 6 goals)**

The story of this edition

Diego Maradona inspired Argentina in 1986.

[All FIFA World Cup editions →](#)



References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 19 August 2026

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- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/spain-argentina-final-report-highlights>)
- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760517/argentina-spain)
- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/2026-fifa-world-cup-final-spain-argentina-sunday/>)
- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/france-england-report-highlights-bronze-final>)

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.